

Seller Protections Policy

Official eBay Standards for Reviewing Disputed Claims and False Claim Investigations (Real Policy Text)

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Source

This document reproduces the official eBay Seller Protections policy, retrieved from ebay.com (eBay Inc.). It is real, live platform policy text describing how eBay reviews disputed claims, investigates false claims, and decides outcomes — the closest real published analog to an internal manual review/escalation process.

1. Overview

When a seller sells on eBay, eBay states it protects them from abusive buying behavior and from events outside their control. If eBay finds a buyer's behavior is abusive, it will take action on the buyer and remove negative and neutral feedback and defects, including opened cases in service metrics.

2. Reviewing a False "Item Not As Described" Claim (Top Rated Sellers)

When a seller reports a buyer and eBay determines the buyer made a false claim, the following review outcomes apply, provided eligibility criteria are met (Top Rated Seller status, US/Canada residence, no "Very High" service metric rating, 30-day+ return window listed):

- eBay may subsidize the return shipping label cost up to \$6.00 per return (credited within 60 days).
- Any related negative or neutral feedback is automatically removed.
- The return is not counted in the seller's "Not as described" rate in service metrics.

Sellers must complete the return and issue a refund to the buyer, and can use the "Report buyer" option within the return request to trigger review.

3. Reviewing Items Returned Used or Damaged by the Buyer

If a seller accepted a buyer's return request but the item is returned in a different condition than originally sent, eBay's review process allows the following, subject to documented guidelines on deduction amounts:

- The seller can deduct up to 50% from the refund to recover the lost value of the item.
- If the buyer's original return reason was that the item didn't match the listing, the return is not counted in the seller's "Item not as described" rate.

Sellers must report the buyer and send the refund within 2 business days after receiving the item back. Sellers are not eligible for fee credits when deducting from a buyer's refund for a used, altered, or damaged return, and

lose this deduction option entirely if eBay steps in to help with the return.

If eBay is asked to step in after the seller has already issued the refund, it will not be counted as a case closed without seller resolution; eBay keeps the return open for up to 10 days while working with the buyer to resolve their concerns.

4. Reviewing Abusive Buying Activity (All Sellers)

When eBay determines that a buyer has violated the Abusive Buyer Policy, it will remove any associated negative or neutral feedback and defects, including open cases in service metrics. For abusive buyers, eBay may also limit their ability to request returns. In serious cases or repeated abusive behavior, eBay may suspend the buyer's account.

Sellers assist this review process by reporting the buyer and clearly describing the behavior at issue, which helps eBay investigate potential policy violations.

5. Reviewing Item-Not-Received Disputes

If a seller ships within their stated handling time and uploads tracking before the estimated delivery date from an eBay-integrated carrier showing evidence of successful delivery, the seller is not responsible for refunding the buyer. If the seller used an eBay label and the item is later delivered to the buyer after a refund was issued, eBay automatically reimburses the seller for the item, removes defects, and excludes the case from service metrics.

When a buyer doesn't ship a return

If eBay doesn't receive proof of shipment from the buyer while a return request is open, eBay removes any negative or neutral feedback left for that transaction once the case is automatically closed.

Duplicate claims

Buyers cannot use more than one resolution method to obtain a refund. If a buyer files a chargeback or buyer protection claim with their payment provider, eBay closes any open "Item not received," return, or order cancellation requests for that transaction, and the buyer cannot open a new request for the same transaction.

6. Conditions That Forfeit Seller Protection (Relevant to Two-Sided Review)

A seller may lose eligibility for seller protections, meaning the review process applies scrutiny to both parties, not just buyers, in the following circumstances:

- Operating with a false identity.
- Failing to follow through on service promises, such as not honoring a stated return policy.
- A history of serious policy violations, such as selling counterfeits, prohibited drop shipping, or taking sales off eBay.
- Shipping using a slower service than the one selected at checkout.

- Abusing or fraudulently using seller protections — for example, a history of reporting buyers for false claims when the item was not actually described correctly, or unfairly deducting more than the actual lost value when an item is returned in a different condition.

This establishes that eBay's review process evaluates patterns and history on both sides of a transaction, not simply accepting either party's claim at face value.

7. Consequences of eBay Stepping In

If eBay steps in to help with a return or item-not-received request: the seller can no longer deduct an amount from the buyer's refund for items returned used or damaged. If eBay determines the seller is responsible for refunding the buyer, negative and neutral feedback will not be removed, and it will count as a "case closed without seller resolution."

8. Fair Performance Evaluation Standards

eBay states its seller performance evaluations are intended to be as fair and accurate as possible. Specifically: the evaluation period is adjusted according to sales volume to ensure a fair sample; the number of different buyers involved is considered when determining whether transaction issues affect account standing; sellers are not subject to service-metric consequences when their issue rate is under 1% in a category, or when fewer than 10 "item not as described" or "item not received" requests have come from unique buyers.